

D.J. PARIS

6.9%. HIGHEST IN THE NATION.

Chicago just posted the biggest annual home-price gain of any major U.S. market.

D.J. Paris
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**CHICAGO IS
OUTPACING THE
NATIONAL MARKET
BY MORE THAN
THREE TO ONE.**

The national composite is up 2.1 percent this year.
Chicago is up 6.9.

EVERY SELLER WHO THINKS THE MARKET SLOWED DOWN IS READING THE WRONG HEADLINE.

The S&P Cotality Case-Shiller Index's June 2026 report, released August 25, put Chicago's year-over-year gain at 6.9 percent, the highest of the 20 tracked metro areas and more than three times the 20-city composite's 2.1 percent gain, ahead of second-place New York at 4.8 and third-place Cleveland at 4.1. The national story sellers are reading describes a market at its slowest pace in a decade. Chicago's own line in that same report tells a different one, and it's the number the agent in the room usually has, and the seller usually doesn't.

WHAT TO SAY AT THIS MONTH'S LISTING APPOINTMENTS:

- 1 Open with the composite, then the local number.**

"The national market grew 2.1 percent this year. Chicago grew 6.9." The gap does the work.
- 2 Use it against "the market is slow."**

That belief comes from a national headline. Chicago's own Case-Shiller number says otherwise.
- 3 Bring it to the price conversation, not just the pitch.**

A seller weighing a price cut needs the same number as a seller deciding whether to list at all.

THE TAKEAWAY

THE MARKET ISN'T SLOW. THE HEADLINE IS NATIONAL.

Chicago's number is the one your seller hasn't seen yet.